

MICHAEL BURGERS

Full-Stack Software Engineer & AI Developer

Cape Town, South Africa | michaelburgers06@gmail.com | github.com/PugLord06 | linkedin.com/in/michaelburgers

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Disciplined, performance-driven 20-year-old South African Software Engineer and 3rd-year BScIT student at Eduvos (Top 15% academic standing, Hollywoodbets & Hollywood Foundation Bursary Recipient). Founder of independent game studio Is It Studios and published creator of isitcheatingif.com (500+ monthly active users). Experienced in full-stack React/Next.js/TypeScript architectures, enterprise Java (Spring Boot, JWT), Python AI integrations, and cloud infrastructure (GCP, Oracle Cloud OCI, Railway, Render). Contributor of formal policy feedback on the Draft South Africa National Artificial Intelligence Policy.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, Python, PHP, Kotlin, SQL (MySQL, SQLite), Shell/Bash, HTML5, CSS3/Sass, MATLAB

Frontend & Mobile: React, Next.js, React Native (Cross-platform Mobile), Tailwind CSS, Vite, Webpack

Backend & Security: Spring Boot, Spring Security (JWT), Node.js, Express, FastAPI, REST API Architecture, WebSockets

Cloud & Infrastructure: Google Cloud (GCP - Expert), Oracle Cloud (OCI - VM Setup, Port Ingress, VCN Routing), Vercel, Netlify, Docker

Databases & Storage: MySQL, SQLite, MongoDB (NoSQL), Firebase, Domain & DNS Management (A, CNAME, TXT, SSL)

Software Engineering & Testing: OOP, Design Patterns, SOLID Principles, Data Structures & Algorithms, Git/GitHub, CI/CD, JUnit, Jest, Vitest, Postman

PROJECT EXPERIENCE & VENTURES

isitcheatingif.com — Flagship Web Platform | *Is It Studios* | *React, Next.js, TypeScript, TailwindCSS*

- Founded independent studio Is It Studios and published viral procedural debate platform serving **500+ monthly active users**.
- Implemented interactive dilemma evaluation logic, real-time vote distribution analytics, and dynamic UI reveal animations.
- Executed advanced SEO strategies to drive organic traffic, maintaining a high 13% Click-Through Rate (CTR) since launch.
- Resolved Next.js SSR hydration state mismatches and optimized structural layout guidelines for Google AdSense approval.

Teamfight Tactics Discord Stats Tracker | *Riot Games Approved API* | *Python, Discord API, REST*

- Engineered a Riot Games-approved Discord statistics tracker for Teamfight Tactics (TFT) calculating live match statistics and leaderboard ranks.
- Configured secure API rate limiting, asynchronous match polling, and custom embeds for active Discord gaming communities.

Java & Spring Boot Web Suite — Enterprise Web Applications | *Java, Spring Boot, Spring Security, JWT, SQL*

- Architected full-stack enterprise Java web applications implementing Spring Boot REST APIs, Dependency Injection, and DTO layers.
- Configured stateless authentication using Spring Security and JSON Web Tokens (JWT) with role-based access control (RBAC).

lekkerfinds.co.za — E-Commerce Platform | *Shopify* | *Liquid* | *Domain Setup*

- Edited Shopify templates using Liquid language to match brand requirements and configured custom domain DNS setup.

burgersdev.xyz — Interactive Developer Portfolio | *React*, *Vite*, *Python*, *FastAPI*, *Gemini AI*

- Engineered a high-performance, interactive developer portfolio showcasing full-stack capabilities and modern web design.
- Integrated a real-time AI Assistant chat powered by a custom Python FastAPI & Google Gemini RAG backend using Server-Sent Events (SSE).

EDUCATION, HONOURS & GOVERNANCE

Bachelor of Science in Information Technology (Software Engineering Specialization) | *Eduvos Cape Town Campus* (2024 – 2026)

- **Academic Distinction:** Maintained top 15% academic standing globally across university cohort.
- **Bursary Recipient:** Awarded the prestigious Hollywoodbets and Hollywood Foundation bursary.
- **Golden Key International Honour Society:** Invited member (Top 15% academic tier).
- **National AI Policy Governance:** Contributed formal policy feedback to the Department of Communications and Digital Technologies (DCDT) on the Draft South Africa National Artificial Intelligence Policy.
- **Global Delegations:** Delegate at youth leadership events including the YES Summit.

Matriculation (IEB/National Senior Certificate) | *De La Salle Holy Cross College High School* (Class of 2023)

Google AI Professional Certificate | *Coursera (Google)* (Completed Feb 26, 2026)